

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
CITY OF MANILA
OFFICE OF THE SANGGUNIANG PANLUNGSOD

CITY ORDINANCE NO. 2026-051

AN ORDINANCE ESTABLISHING A SOCIALIZED HOUSING AND IN-CITY RELOCATION
PROGRAM FOR INFORMAL SETTLER FAMILIES IN THE CITY OF MANILA

Sponsor: Hon. Councilor Eduardo M. Bautista | Presiding Officer: Hon. Vice Mayor Maria Elena T. Cruz

PREAMBLE

WHEREAS, a significant number of informal settler families reside in danger zones and along waterways within the City of Manila;

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 7279, the Urban Development and Housing Act, mandates local government units to provide adequate resettlement or in-city housing for displaced informal settlers;

WHEREAS, in-city relocation preserves access to livelihood, education, and health services for affected families;

WHEREAS, the City Government has identified suitable government-owned lots for the development of medium-rise socialized housing units;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT ORDAINED by the Sangguniang Panlungsod in session assembled, that:

SECTION 1. Title. This Ordinance shall be known as the "Manila Socialized Housing and In-City Relocation Ordinance of 2026."

SECTION 2. Declaration of Policy. The City of Manila shall prioritize in-city, on-site, or near-site relocation of informal settler families in accordance with RA 7279.

SECTION 3. Housing Development. The City Housing Authority shall develop medium-rise socialized housing units on identified City-owned properties within thirty-six (36) months from effectivity.

SECTION 4. Beneficiary Selection. Beneficiaries shall be selected based on a validated list of qualified informal settler families residing in danger zones, subject to a public consultation process.

SECTION 5. Amortization Scheme. Qualified beneficiaries shall pay a subsidized monthly amortization not exceeding ten percent (10%) of household income, payable over twenty-five (25) years.

SECTION 6. Appropriation. The City shall allocate funds under the Local Housing Program budget and may access national housing subsidies and grants.

SECTION 7. Effectivity. This Ordinance shall take effect fifteen (15) days after publication in a newspaper of general circulation.

EVALUATION CRITERIA COMPLIANCE STATEMENT

In accordance with the City's legislative evaluation standards, this Ordinance addresses the following criteria:

1. Economic Feasibility

Project cost is estimated at Php 480 million for 1,200 housing units, funded through a combination of City capital outlay (40%), national government housing subsidy under the Department of Human Settlements and Urban Development (45%), and beneficiary amortization collections (15%). A cost-recovery period of twenty-five (25) years is projected based on subsidized amortization rates, which is within the City's long-term capital investment plan.

2. Social Impact

The program directly benefits approximately 1,200 informal settler families (an estimated 6,000 individuals), improving housing security and reducing exposure to flooding and fire hazards. In-city relocation minimizes disruption to beneficiaries' existing livelihoods, school enrollment, and access to health facilities, addressing concerns typically raised against off-city resettlement sites.

3. Environmental Impact

Vacating danger zones along waterways is expected to reduce garbage accumulation and illegal structures obstructing natural drainage, contributing to improved flood mitigation. The housing development shall comply with green building and solid waste management standards, including rainwater catchment and segregated waste facilities per unit cluster.

4. Legal Compliance

This Ordinance is enacted pursuant to the Sangguniang Panlungsod's legislative authority under Section 447 of the Local Government Code (RA 7160) and is consistent with the resettlement and relocation procedures mandated under RA 7279. Land acquisition and beneficiary selection shall follow due process, including public consultation and a formal appeals mechanism for excluded households.

ENACTED: September 10, 2026

Hon. Eduardo M. Bautista
Sponsor, City Councilor

Hon. Maria Elena T. Cruz
Presiding Officer, City Vice Mayor